

Classroom Observation Report Paul, design Grade 11

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Classroom Environment & Physical Setup

The atmosphere was focused yet relaxed.

Students were arranged in a non-traditional formation, sitting around a table.

Each student had a personal computer open in front of them.

Several students were eating while working, which contributed to a low-stress, studio-like environment.

Student Behavior & Engagement

Nice casual atmosphere (snacks, open laptops)

Students were highly attentive.

When the teacher addressed the group or when peer discussion occurred, students immediately shifted focus from their screens.

Students were leaning into their screens, typing, and occasionally turning to neighbors to show their work. No off-task browsing or distraction.

Teacher Observation

Rather than lecturing from a front desk or podium, Paul was walking around the table, he stopped by individual screens and engaged in inquiry

He was smiling, which seemed to lower students' affective filters (fear of making mistakes). His posture was open and non-threatening.

Paul was fully available and immerse in his teaching.

He never dismissed a raised hand or a student's muttered question.

He moved closer to student when needed.

Lesson Structure & Activity Analysis

Moodle-based Word Manipulation (X/Y Axis Chart) on Moodle

Paul has designed a sophisticated digital activity hosted on the school's Moodle platform. Instead of a standard quiz or forum, the activity requires students to engage in taxonomic sorting.

The Task: Students are given a bank of "material" words (likely relating to design principles, materials science, or aesthetic vocabulary). They must physically drag or type these words into a two-dimensional X and Y axes chart.

This is not a simple matching exercise. By using X and Y axes, Paul forces students to consider relative qualities. This requires higher-order thinking (analysis and evaluation).

Technology Integration: Moodle is used not just as a repository, but as an interactive manipulative formative assessment. This transforms a reading lesson into a hands-on logic puzzle.

General observation

Paul's approach is human, passionate, directed and inspiring. His constant movement and smiling serve as subtle classroom management; he is aware of every screen without hovering. Paul also uses a clear, well paced voice with a pleasant tone.

The Moodle activity is a best-practice example of blended learning. It takes abstract conceptual relationships (e.g., Form vs. Function) and makes them tangible through digital manipulation. Paul's role is not to give answers, but to observe the process of how students sort the words, and helping when needed.

I particularly enjoyed the low pressure environment enabling students to feel safe and explore rather than having to provide clear answers and knowledge.

Constructive Feedback (Minor suggestions for an already excellent lesson)

- Paul could give a specific timeline to complete the task so student practice their time management
- Students could work together to discuss their strategies and reuse the terminology to ensure a deeper understanding and mastering of the vocabulary.
- When creating activities, Paul could explicitly identify which skills are needed or being develop for students to target and build their self-awareness and their own development.